STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Software Application Unblock Request

Endpoint Support → Application Management

SOP ID	SOP-L1-APP-001
Support Level	L1 Service Desk
Category	Endpoint Support / Application Management
Primary Remediation Path	IFEO Debugger Entry Removal
Document Version	1.0
Status	Approved for Use
Classification	Internal Use Only

This document defines the standard, command-based process for identifying an application block caused by an Image File Execution Options (IFEO) debugger entry and removing it as a fallback remediation on a Windows endpoint.

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1. Objective

Restore access to an approved software application that is blocked on a Windows endpoint by identifying the blocking mechanism and applying the appropriate remediation. If the block is caused by an Image File Execution Options (IFEO) debugger entry, remove the entry as a fallback remediation.

2. Preconditions

- Ticket assigned to L1 Engineer.
- Remote administrative access to the endpoint.
- User device is online.
- Administrative privileges available.

3. Process Flow Overview

The diagram below summarizes the end-to-end decision flow. Full instructions for each stage are provided in Section 4, Detailed Procedure.

Is the application blocked via an IFEO Debugger entry? (Step 2)

YES — IFEO Debugger Entry Found	NO — Registry Key Not Found
Proceed to Step 3 — remove the Debugger entry (and the key itself if it exists solely to block the app), then refresh policy and verify.	Application is not blocked through IFEO. Investigate AppLocker, WDAC, Intune, or Endpoint Security policies, or escalate to L2.

4. Detailed Procedure

STEP 1 — Verify Endpoint Connectivity

Command

```
Test-Connection <ComputerName> -Count 2
```

✔ Expected Result: Reply received from target system.

If unreachable — Action:

- Verify VPN / network connectivity.
- Retry.
- Escalate if unreachable.

STEP 2 — Identify Application Blocking Mechanism

Command

```
reg query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Image File Execution Options\<Application>.exe"
```

Expected Result 1

```
Debugger    REG_SZ    ...
```

Result: Application is blocked using IFEO. Proceed to Step 3.

Expected Result 2

```
ERROR:
The system was unable to find the specified registry key.
```

Result: Application is not blocked through IFEO. Investigate other blocking technologies (AppLocker, WDAC, Intune, Endpoint Security) or escalate to L2.

STEP 3 — Remove IFEO Block (Fallback)

Execute only when Step 2 confirms an IFEO Debugger entry.

Remove Debugger Value

```
reg delete "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Image File Execution Options\<Application>.exe" ^
  /v Debugger /f
```

If the application-specific IFEO key was created only for blocking, remove the key:

```
reg delete "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Image File Execution Options\<Application>.exe" ^
  /f
```

STEP 4 — Refresh Local Policy

Command

```
gpupdate /force
```

✔ Expected Result: Computer Policy update has completed successfully. User Policy update has completed successfully.

STEP 5 — Verify Block Removal

Command

```
reg query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Image File Execution Options\<Application>.exe"
```

✔ *Expected Result: ERROR: The system was unable to find the specified registry key — or — Debugger value not present.*

STEP 6 — Validate Resolution

Ask the user to launch the application.

✔ *Expected Result:*

- Application launches successfully.
- No error message displayed.
- User confirms issue resolved.

If the application remains blocked:

- Check for AppLocker policies.
- Check WDAC policies.
- Check Endpoint Security policies.
- Escalate to L2 Support.

STEP 7 — Update Ticket

Resolution Notes

```
Issue:
Application launch blocked.

Root Cause:
IFEO Debugger registry entry prevented application execution.

Action Taken:
Verified IFEO configuration.
Removed Debugger registry entry.
Refreshed Group Policy.
Validated successful application launch.

Status:
Resolved.
```

5. Escalation Criteria

Escalate to L2 if:

- IFEO key not present.
- Application blocked by WDAC.
- Application blocked by AppLocker.
- Endpoint protection policy prevents execution.
- Registry modification fails.
- User lacks required permissions.
- Application still fails after remediation.

6. Document Control

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